

QUIET BIG

Former beauty queen and VJ **Sarah Jane Dias**, 27, may just be the next big thing in Bollywood. If all goes well, she will soon step into Aishwarya Rai Bachchan's shoes as the female lead in *Crooked* opposite Abhishek Bachchan. It turns out Ash had to step out due to a full calendar. And Dias seems to have grabbed the opportunity. But she's superstitious already. "I have been asked not to make any comments," is all she says. Why hide such good news, Sarah?



POWER OF THREE

An IIT Chennai trio is making India proud. **Sriram Kalyanaraman**, 24, **Aashish Dattani**, 23, and **Vinayshankar Kulkarni**, 24, recently won New York's Next Big Idea competition. Their project allows power companies to store solar energy in battery sites which can be released to grids when required. They were also awarded \$20,000 by New York Mayor Michael Bloomberg. Three isn't a crowd here.



(L TO R) KALYANARAMAN, DATTANI AND KULKARNI

THE KARATE KID

She's defied all odds and emerged triumphant. **Asma Parween**, 19, may have spent her entire life in an impoverished village in Muzaffarpur, but she's shining bright on the United Nations Population Fund Calendar 2010. Despite resistance from her father, Parween has now become a karate instructor, supplementing her family's income. She wants the Government to set up an all-girl Urdu school so people like her can fulfil their dreams. "My brothers are labourers and now I can help them financially," she says.

ARJUN CHANDELE, JAGRAN TEHEL



SERIES MAJOR

A few Balaji serials later, **Panchi Bora**, 23, all but disappeared. But it turns out that she's been in Russia all this while. Bora has just finished shooting for a Russian TV series called *The Hindu*, a love story between an Indian girl and a Russian boy that was shot in Moscow and Mumbai. Take One, the production house, saw her work on TV, auditioned her and finally gave her the thumbs up. "It'll be on air in April. I wish people in India could also see it," she says. We wish so too.



**TASTES SO HOT,
CAN CAUSE FIRE.**

